

Crime Sense : Video-Based Crime Classification
Using Deep Learning

Bachelor of Technology
in
Computer Science

B.Tech Thesis Project
Mid-Term Evaluation Report

by

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MARCH 2025

CANDIDATE DECLARATION

I hereby certify that the work, which is being presented in the report, entitled **Crime Sense : Video-Based Crime Classification Using Deep Learning**, in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of the Degree of **Bachelor of Technology** and submitted to the institution is an authentic record of my work carried out during the period *January 2025* to *March 2025* under the supervision of **Dr. Vivek Tiwari**. I have also cited the reference to the text(s)/figure(s)/table(s) from where they have been taken.

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ABSTRACT

Crime classification is a crucial aspect of modern law enforcement, significantly enhancing crime detection, prevention, and investigation. With the increasing availability of surveillance footage and crime scene imagery, deep learning techniques have emerged as powerful tools to automate and improve the accuracy of crime classification. Traditional methods, which rely on manual observation, forensic analysis, and rule-based approaches, often prove to be time-consuming, prone to human errors, and inefficient in handling large-scale data. To address these limitations, this research explores the application of advanced deep learning models, including Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs), Recurrent Neural Networks (RNNs) to classify various types of crimes using images and videos.

The study utilizes the UCF Crime Dataset, a well-established benchmark dataset comprising diverse crime-related video footage. A comprehensive data preprocessing pipeline is implemented to enhance the quality of input data, which includes frame extraction, image augmentation, noise reduction, motion pattern analysis, and feature extraction. These preprocessing steps are essential to improve the robustness and generalization capability of the models. The project evaluates multiple deep learning architectures, comparing their effectiveness based on key performance metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score. Additionally, various model optimization techniques, including transfer learning, hyperparameter tuning, and attention mechanisms, are explored to improve detection accuracy and computational efficiency.

The primary goal of this research is to develop a real-time crime detection system capable of processing both static images and dynamic video streams. By leveraging deep learning advancements, the proposed system aims to significantly reduce manual effort for investigators, enhance the speed of crime identification, and improve overall accuracy in recognizing criminal activities. The system is designed for real-time deployment, potentially integrated into a web-based platform for accessibility and operational efficiency.

Acknowledgement

I owe allegiance of gratitude to Dr. Vivek Tiwari for allowing me the independence to work and try out new concepts. I would like to take this opportunity to express my sincere gratitude to them for their academic advice as well as for their interest in my project and ongoing support, along with the sessions they held to boost our confidence and motivate us. These sessions proved to be very successful and were crucial in helping to instil self-confidence and trust in me. They provided invaluable advice, recommendations, sage judgement, constructive criticism, and an eye for perfection that helped the current work grow and flourish. My mentor never made us feel like a rookie by constantly listening to our questions and always responding to them with graciousness and extraordinary patience.

Finally, I am grateful to my Institution and colleagues whose constant encouragement served to renew my spirit, refocus my attention and energy and help me in carrying out this work.

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ABBREVIATIONS

CNN	Convolutional Neural Network
RNN	Recurrent Neural Network
LSTM	Long Short-Term Memory
GRU	Gated Recurrent Unit
YOLO	You Only Look Once (Object Detection Model)
ResNet	Residual Network
VGG16	Visual Geometry Group 16-layer Model
DenseNet	Densely Connected Convolutional Network
Xception	Extreme Inception Model
UCF	University of Central Florida (Dataset Source)
FPS	Frames Per Second

CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

Crime detection and classification are crucial aspects of modern law enforcement, aiding in surveillance, investigation, and public safety. With the rapid increase in criminal activities, traditional crime detection methods relying on manual monitoring and forensic analysis are becoming inefficient. The sheer volume of surveillance footage generated daily makes it impossible for human operators to analyze and classify crimes in real time. Deep learning, particularly video-based crime classification models, has emerged as a powerful solution to automate this process. By leveraging advanced neural network architectures, we can develop intelligent systems that detect and classify criminal activities from surveillance footage with high accuracy.

This project focuses on video-based crime classification using deep learning, specifically employing a Hybrid CNN-LSTM model. Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) are used to extract spatial features from individual frames, while Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks analyze temporal dependencies to recognize sequential crime patterns. This combination enables the model to not only detect crime-related objects (e.g., weapons, masked faces) but also to understand how criminal activities unfold over time. The primary dataset used in this project is the UCF Crime Dataset, which contains real-world surveillance footage of crimes such as robbery, assault, and vandalism. By training our model on this dataset, we aim to develop a robust crime detection system capable of real-time analysis.

Unlike traditional image-based crime classification models, which only analyze static frames, our Hybrid CNN-LSTM approach provides a more comprehensive analysis by incorporating both spatial and temporal features. This makes it highly effective in identifying complex crimes that involve progressive actions over time, such as fights, break-ins, and theft. Additionally, we compare our approach with other deep learning models, including standalone CNNs, RNNs, YOLO to evaluate its performance. The goal is to optimize model accuracy, computational efficiency, and real-time applicability for practical deployment in law enforcement agencies.

This introduction sets the stage for my project, highlighting the critical role of Deep Learning in detecting crime and emphasizing the need for innovative solutions to address the complexities of detecting crime in the real time.

1.1 Background

Crime has been a persistent challenge for societies worldwide, affecting public safety, economic stability, and social well-being. As cities grow and surveillance infrastructure expands, the amount of video data collected by CCTV cameras, body cams, and other surveillance systems has increased exponentially.

However, manually monitoring and analyzing this footage is time-consuming, labor-intensive, and prone to human errors. Traditional crime detection methods often rely on manual video review, forensic analysis, and witness reports, which can result in delays and inefficiencies in law enforcement operations. Automated crime classification using deep learning offers a solution by leveraging artificial intelligence to analyze and detect criminal activities in real time, thereby enhancing security measures and expediting crime prevention.

The emergence of deep learning techniques, particularly in computer vision and video processing, has significantly improved the ability to classify crimes based on surveillance footage. By utilizing Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) for spatial feature extraction and Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks for temporal pattern recognition, deep learning models can detect and categorize crimes more efficiently than traditional rule-based systems. The UCF Crime Dataset, which contains labeled real-world crime footage, provides an essential benchmark for training and evaluating such models. As deep learning models continue to advance, their integration into real-time crime monitoring systems has the potential to revolutionize law enforcement and public safety.

1.2 Motivation

With the increasing prevalence of criminal activities, law enforcement agencies require faster, more accurate, and scalable crime detection solutions. The manual review of thousands of hours of surveillance footage is impractical, leading to delays in crime intervention. A deep learning-based crime classification system can automate this process, reducing human workload and increasing efficiency. Furthermore, integrating real-time crime detection into a web-based platform would allow users to upload and analyze crime footage instantly, making this technology accessible to security agencies, law enforcement, and even smart city infrastructures. The motivation is to develop a robust, scalable, and accurate crime classification system that enhances crime detection and response times while minimizing human effort.

1.3 Problem Statement

Despite advancements in video surveillance and artificial intelligence, existing crime detection methods face significant challenges in automating crime recognition, reducing false positives, and handling large-scale video data. Current models either focus on object detection (e.g., detecting a weapon) without understanding context or are limited to static image-based classification rather than video-based crime detection. There is a need for a hybrid deep learning approach that combines spatial and temporal analysis to accurately classify crimes from surveillance footage. This project aims to develop a Hybrid CNN-LSTM model that can analyze crime sequences, detect anomalies, and classify different crime types using real-world datasets, making crime detection more efficient and accurate.

1.4 Objectives

1. **Collection and Preprocessing of Dataset** – Acquire and preprocess the UCF Crime Dataset, which contains labeled crime footage, ensuring data augmentation and enhancement for better model performance.
2. **Deep Learning Model Exploration**– Implement and compare CNNs, RNNs (LSTM/GRU), YOLO, Vision Transformers, and Hybrid CNN-LSTM models to identify the most effective approach for crime classification.

3. **Develop a Web-Based Crime Detection System-** Build a user-friendly web platform where law enforcement agencies can upload images or videos for real-time crime detection using the trained deep learning model.
4. **Optimize and Deploy the Model** - Fine-tune the Hybrid CNN-LSTM model for real-time processing and integrate it into cloud-based or edge computing platforms to enable fast and scalable crime classification.

CHAPTER 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

This chapter presents a review of the most relevant research in the field of crime classification using deep learning. Section 2.1 provides an overview of related work, followed by Section 2.2, which summarizes these studies. Section 2.3 highlights the research gap and how our approach differs from existing methodologies.

2.1 Related Work

Several studies have focused on crime classification using deep learning, image recognition, video-based crime detection, and text-based crime reports. This section discusses key research papers and their methodologies.

The study presented in [1] proposed a CNN-based crime classification model for detecting violent activities in still images. The authors utilized a pre-trained ResNet50 model trained on a dataset containing crime-related images, including cases of assault, burglary, and vandalism. The approach focused on extracting spatial features from images, achieving an accuracy of 85% . However, since CNNs only analyze static images, this model could not capture temporal crime sequences , making it less suitable for crime detection in videos.

Similarly, in [2], the authors implemented an object detection-based approach using YOLOv4 to identify weapons, suspicious individuals, and violent acts in crime scene images. The dataset consisted of labeled crime-related images from real-world surveillance cameras. YOLOv4's ability to detect multiple objects in real-time made it a promising candidate for live crime detection systems. However, its limitation was that while it could detect objects, it could not analyze the progression of events , which is crucial for crime classification in videos.

The research conducted in [3] focused on video-based crime classification using an LSTM-based model trained on the UCF Crime Dataset . The model was designed to recognize sequential patterns of violent actions such as fighting, arson, and robbery . By processing frames in a sequential manner, the model achieved high classification accuracy compared to traditional image-based crime classifiers. However, a major drawback was its reliance on manually engineered features , limiting its adaptability to unseen data and real-world scenarios.

In [4], the authors implemented a Vision Transformer (ViT)-based model for video-based crime classification . Unlike CNNs, which rely on local feature extraction , ViTs analyze global dependencies across an image. The model achieved higher accuracy in complex crime scenarios , but due to the high computational cost , real-time deployment was impractical. The study emphasized the potential of transformer-based architectures but highlighted the need for optimized implementations for real-world crime detection.

A recent study [5] explored multi-modal learning by integrating audio and video inputs for crime detection. The model combined speech recognition with video classification to detect verbal and physical cues of criminal activities. The dataset used contained synchronized audio-visual recordings of real-world crimes. This approach achieved a significant accuracy improvement over single-modal methods. However, its limitation was the need for large-scale multi-modal datasets and extensive computational resources, making deployment challenging.

The work by [6] proposed a real-time crime detection system using lightweight MobileNet-based CNN models. The authors aimed to develop a low-power, edge-compatible solution for real-time crime detection in mobile and IoT devices. The model was trained on a subset of the UCF Crime Dataset, achieving efficient classification at lower computational costs. While promising for on-device crime monitoring, its accuracy was lower than deeper networks, making it less reliable for high-stakes surveillance applications.

An innovative approach in [7] introduced deep reinforcement learning for crime prediction and analysis. The model dynamically learned from streaming surveillance data, continuously improving its crime classification accuracy. By employing a reinforcement learning framework, the system could adapt to new crime patterns over time. Despite its novelty, the method required complex training setups and significant processing power, limiting its immediate real-world application.

Additionally, several studies have explored text-based crime classification using natural language processing (NLP) techniques. In [8], the authors implemented a BERT-based classifier to analyze police reports and categorize crime types based on textual descriptions. Similarly, [9] proposed a TF-IDF and LSTM-based model to extract crime patterns from social media posts and news reports. These approaches demonstrated promising results in crime text analysis, but they lacked the ability to integrate textual data with video-based crime detection, which is a key focus of our study.

2.2 Research Gap

Despite significant advancements in crime classification, existing approaches have several limitations. Traditional CNN-based models are effective for analyzing static crime scene images, but they fail to capture sequential dependencies in crime sequences, making them inadequate for video-based classification. Transformer-based models, while highly accurate, are computationally expensive, limiting their feasibility for real-time crime detection in law enforcement applications. Many studies focus on improving accuracy but do not explore real-time integration with surveillance systems, making them impractical for automated crime monitoring. Additionally, most existing research either focuses on image based crime classification or text-based crime prediction, but not video based, leading to incomplete crime detection solutions.

To address these gaps, this research proposes a Hybrid CNN-LSTM Model for Crime Classification. The methodology combines CNNs for spatial feature extraction and LSTMs for temporal sequence analysis to enhance the accuracy of crime detection in videos. The model is optimized for computational efficiency to ensure real-time crime classification and is designed for deployment as a web-based crime classification system, where users can upload crime-related images or videos for automated detection. Furthermore, a dataset preprocessing pipeline is integrated to enhance model robustness, ensuring the system can operate efficiently across different crime scenarios. By bridging the gap between video and image-based crime analysis, this approach provides a more comprehensive, real-time, and deployable crime detection system for law enforcement and public safety applications.

CHAPTER 3

METHODOLOGY

In this section, we provide a comprehensive methodology for the implementation of the Crime Classification. The methodology encompasses the definition of entities, dataset, preprocessing and Model exploration.

3.1 Dataset

The dataset utilized in this study is derived from the UCF Crime Dataset, a widely recognized benchmark for crime classification tasks. Unlike traditional datasets that consist of raw video footage, this dataset has been preprocessed to extract individual frames from every video, ensuring that critical moments in crime sequences are captured. Specifically, every 10th frame from each full-length crime video is selected, allowing the model to process a representative subset of frames without redundant or unnecessary data. This technique ensures computational efficiency while maintaining enough temporal variation to distinguish between different criminal activities. Each extracted frame is stored in .png format, ensuring consistency across the dataset and facilitating seamless input into deep learning models.

The dataset encompasses 14 distinct crime categories, covering a diverse range of criminal activities and normal behavior. These categories include Abuse, Arrest, Arson, Assault, Burglary, Explosion, Fighting, Normal Videos, Road Accidents, Robbery, Shooting, Shoplifting, Stealing, and Vandalism. The inclusion of a "Normal Videos" class is particularly important, as it helps the model differentiate between crime-related and non-criminal activities, reducing false positives in real-world applications. Each category is well-represented, ensuring that the model does not develop biases towards any single type of crime. The variation in crime types also ensures robustness, making the dataset applicable to real-time surveillance, law enforcement, and automated security systems.

In terms of dataset scale, it contains a total of 1,266,345 images in the training set and 111,308 images in the testing set, making it one of the largest available datasets for crime classification. The large dataset size plays a crucial role in enhancing the generalization ability of the deep learning model, reducing the risk of overfitting. The distribution of images across different crime categories ensures that the model is exposed to a wide range of crime-related patterns, leading to improved accuracy in distinguishing between different criminal activities. Additionally, the presence of high-volume training data allows for the implementation of data augmentation techniques, further improving model robustness.

3.2 Data Preprocessing

Data preprocessing is a crucial step to ensure that the dataset is in an optimal format for model training. Since the dataset consists of images extracted from videos, several preprocessing techniques are applied to enhance model performance.

3.2.1 Frame Selection

Frame Selection is performed to extract meaningful information while reducing redundancy. Since every 10th frame is taken from each video, this ensures that there is enough variation between frames while maintaining essential context. Selecting every frame could lead to unnecessary computational overhead, whereas selecting too few frames might result in missing critical moments in crime sequences.

3.2.2 Image resizing and Normalization

Image resizing and Normalization are applied to standardize the input format for the deep learning models. Each extracted frame is resized to 64×64 pixels to maintain uniformity across the dataset. Normalization is performed by scaling pixel values between 0 and 1, which helps improve training stability and prevents issues like exploding gradients.

3.2.3 Data Augmentation

To enhance the diversity of the dataset and prevent overfitting, data augmentation is applied. Various transformations are performed, including rotation, flipping, brightness adjustment, and Gaussian noise addition. Rotation and flipping help the model become invariant to different orientations of crime scenes, while brightness adjustment ensures robustness under different lighting conditions. Gaussian noise addition helps in making the model resistant to real-world noise and artifacts present in surveillance footage.

3.2.4 Optical flow analysis

Optical flow analysis is performed to extract motion-based features from videos. Since crime activities involve movement, optical flow methods help in capturing motion patterns between consecutive frames. This is particularly useful for differentiating violent and non-violent activities, such as a person walking normally versus a person involved in a physical altercation.

Finally, the preprocessed images are structured into sequences suitable for the Hybrid CNN-LSTM model. The CNN component processes individual frames to extract spatial features, while the LSTM component analyzes the sequence of frames to capture temporal dependencies. This structured approach ensures that the model can learn both static and dynamic patterns in crime-related activities, leading to improved classification accuracy.

3.3 Model Exploration

Several deep learning models will be explored in this study to determine the best-performing architecture for crime classification.

3.3.1 Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs)

Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) are deep learning models designed to process spatial data such as images. CNNs utilize convolutional layers to extract hierarchical features from images, including

edges, textures, and complex patterns. A typical CNN architecture consists of convolutional layers, activation functions (ReLU), pooling layers, and fully connected layers.

3.3.2 ResNet

ResNet (Residual Network) is an advanced CNN architecture designed to tackle vanishing gradient issues in deep networks. It introduces skip connections that allow gradients to flow smoothly during training, improving feature learning in deeper architectures. ResNet can effectively learn high-level crime scene patterns, making it useful for detecting criminal activities in images.

3.3.3 VGG16

VGG16 is a widely used CNN model consisting of 16 layers, primarily composed of convolutional and pooling layers. It uses small 3x3 filters to systematically learn hierarchical image features. VGG16 is beneficial for crime classification because of its structured feature extraction process. However, due to its high computational cost, lighter architectures such as ResNet and DenseNet are preferred for real-time applications.

3.3.4 YOLO (You Only Look Once)

YOLO is an object detection model that processes an image in a single forward pass, making it highly efficient for real-time crime detection. YOLO divides an image into a grid and predicts multiple bounding boxes and class probabilities simultaneously. In this project, YOLO is leveraged to detect weapons, suspicious behavior, and crime-related objects in surveillance footage. Unlike classification models, YOLO provides localized detection, making it useful for identifying crime-related elements in video frames.

3.3.5 DenseNet121

DenseNet121 improves feature propagation by densely connecting layers, ensuring better feature reuse and reducing the number of parameters. This allows the model to achieve higher accuracy with fewer computations. DenseNet is particularly useful for analyzing complex crime environments, where multiple elements interact in a scene. The interconnected nature of DenseNet helps in enhancing crime classification accuracy.

3.3.6 Xception

Xception is a CNN variant that uses depthwise separable convolutions to optimize feature extraction. It improves efficiency by reducing computational overhead while maintaining classification accuracy. Xception is beneficial for processing high-resolution crime scene images, as it can efficiently extract fine-grained details with lower computational cost.

3.3.7 Hybrid CNN-LSTM Model (Proposed Approach)

To address the limitations of CNNs in crime classification, I propose a Hybrid CNN-LSTM Model. This model combines spatial feature extraction from CNNs with sequential learning capabilities of LSTMs. The workflow is as follows:

- CNN extracts spatial features from individual video frames.

- Extracted features are fed into an LSTM network to capture temporal dependencies between frames.
- The LSTM output is passed through fully connected layers for final crime classification.

This approach is ideal for crime detection in surveillance footage, as it learns both static and motion-related crime patterns, leading to enhanced accuracy in crime classification tasks.

This approach outperforms traditional CNN models as it learns the context of crime sequences rather than analyzing frames independently. The CNN-LSTM hybrid is well-suited for real-time crime detection in surveillance footage.

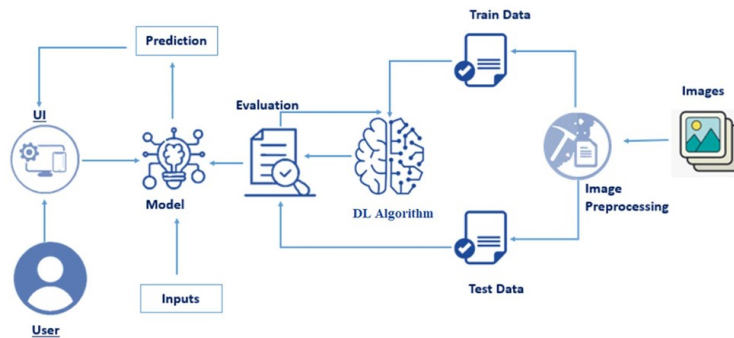


Figure 3.1: Architecture of the Project

CHAPTER 4

Work to be Done

The primary objective of this research is to develop a deep learning-based crime classification system that accurately identifies various criminal activities from images and videos. To achieve this, several crucial tasks need to be completed, ranging from model exploration and training to optimization, performance comparison, and final deployment. The process involves not only implementing and experimenting with different deep learning architectures but also understanding their fundamental concepts, optimizing their performance, and evaluating their suitability for real-world applications.

The first step in this research is to explore and understand various deep learning models that can be used for crime classification. Since different architectures excel in different aspects of image and video processing, it is essential to analyze their characteristics and determine which models are best suited for this task. Models such as Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs), ResNet, VGG16, YOLO, DenseNet121, Xception, and Hybrid CNN-LSTM will be studied in detail to comprehend their working principles, advantages, and limitations. A deep understanding of these models will enable us to make informed decisions about their implementation and modification to enhance classification performance.

Once a solid understanding of the models is established, the next step is to train and evaluate them on the crime classification dataset. The UCF Crime Dataset will be used as the primary dataset, where extracted frames from crime videos serve as input for model training. Each model will be trained on this dataset to classify different crime categories, and their performance will be evaluated using metrics such as accuracy, precision, recall, and F1-score. Since different models process information differently, extensive experimentation will be conducted to fine-tune hyperparameters, such as learning rate, batch size, and number of layers, to achieve optimal performance.

To improve the effectiveness of the crime classification system, various optimization techniques will be applied. Deep learning models often require high computational power, and optimizing them can significantly enhance both training efficiency and real-time classification accuracy. Techniques such as dropout regularization, batch normalization, data augmentation, and model pruning will be explored to enhance model robustness. Additionally, transfer learning will be considered, where pre-trained models on large-scale datasets can be fine-tuned on the crime classification dataset to improve accuracy and reduce training time. These optimization strategies will help in reducing overfitting, improving generalization, and ensuring that the model performs well on real-world crime footage.

After training and optimizing the models, the results of each model will be compared to determine the best-performing architecture. Since crime classification requires both spatial and temporal understanding, standalone CNNs and object detection models like YOLO may perform well for detecting crime-related objects, while sequential models like LSTMs may excel in recognizing patterns in videos. The Hybrid CNN-LSTM model, which integrates both spatial and temporal learning, is expected to outperform other architectures. Each model's results will be analyzed and visualized to gain insights into

their strengths and weaknesses. This comparison will provide a clear understanding of which model is best suited for real-time crime detection applications.

The final step in this research is to deploy the high-performing model as a crime classification system. A user-friendly web-based application will be developed where users can upload images or videos, and the trained model will classify the type of crime present in the input data. The deployment process will involve integrating the model with a backend server that processes incoming requests, runs the crime classification algorithm, and returns results to the user interface. This application will serve as a real-time crime detection tool that can assist law enforcement agencies, security personnel, and research organizations in identifying and analyzing criminal activities efficiently.

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